Running the PaperJet

From switching on to cleaning down. Loading paper, the hand control panel and its five modes, and keeping the machine running.



Supplied by **Cotswold Packaging Group**
Based on the Sprick PaperJet operating manual, version 3.4

What the PaperJet does

It turns flat recycled paper into cushioning pads, cut to the length you set, on demand at the packing bench.

SPEED	Up to 1.2 metres a second.
LENGTHS	30 cm to 1015 cm, set to the centimetre.
PAPER	PaperJet paper rolls, or ComPackt fanfold stacks. Use PaperJet paper only.
POWER	Normal mains, 110 to 240 V. Rated 1450 W.
SIZE	About 1110 × 755 × 280 mm, about 55 kg on its own.

In the box

- PaperJet machine and power supply
- Hand control panel and its support rod
- Foot switch
- **Special tool for the knife shaft** (the spanner)
- Cable ties and operating manual
- Stand: ComPackt, EuPal or middle stand

The machine stays the property of Sprick and is supplied on loan.

What's where on the machine

1. **Service panels**, underneath. Open for cleaning only.
2. **Hand control panel** socket
3. **Foot switch** socket
4. **Paper outlet**, where the pads come out
5. **Emergency stop**, the red mushroom button
6. **Service hood**, covers the cutting area
7. **Paper guide cover**, opens to thread paper
8. **Deflector rollers**, the paper runs between them
9. **On/off switch** and power socket
10. **Dancer arm**, keeps the roll under light tension
11. **Roll lock** with locking knob
12. **Roll seat**, where the paper roll sits

Numbers follow the parts overview in the manual (Fig. 7). The paper guide cover and service hood both have safety switches: the machine will not run with them open.

Safety first

- Only trained operators use the machine.
- **Switch off** before you put a hand inside it, for any reason.
- Close-fitting clothes, long hair tied back, no gloves when loading paper. The rollers can pull things in.
- Never run it with the service panels open. A marking inside shows from a distance if they are.
- Do not move the machine while it is plugged in.

Emergency stop. Place the machine so the red button is always in reach. Press it to stop everything. Never use it to clear a fault message.

Pacemakers. The hand control panel has magnets. Anyone with a pacemaker or defibrillator keeps at least 26 cm away from it.

Heavy paper: one person up to 15 kg. A 27 kg roll or a 24 kg ComPackt stack needs two people.

Set up and switch on

1. Position the machine so the emergency stop, hand control panel and foot switch are all easy to reach.
2. Plug the **foot switch** into its socket on the machine.
3. Plug the **hand control panel** into its socket.
4. Connect the power lead to the machine, then to the wall.
5. Pull the **emergency stop** out if it is pressed in.
6. Flip the **on/off rocker switch** to on. The display lights up.

Cables

- No extension lead longer than 10 m, and no multi-way blocks.
- Run cables out of walkways so nobody trips, and tie them up with the cable ties supplied.

If paper is not loaded yet, load it before you start producing pads. The next slides show how.

Load a paper roll 1: fit the roll

> **Switch off first.** No gloves, sleeves tight. Two people for a 27 kg roll.

1. Push the roll into the **roll seat**.
2. Pull the **locking knob** and swing the roll lock round in front of the roll. Check the knob clicks back in.
3. Open the **quick-release catches** on both sides of the paper guide cover.
4. Lift the **paper guide cover**. Check its support pin catches so it stays open.

Why the roll lock matters

If the roll is not locked it can slide sideways, and the paper web keeps tearing. It is the first thing to check if pads keep breaking.

Load a paper roll 2: thread the paper

5. Push the **dancer arm** in the direction of the arrow to release the roll brake.
6. Feed the paper **under the dancer arm** and leave a loose loop, so it is not under tension.
7. Feed it **between the deflector rollers**.
8. Wrap it round the **paper guide** so it forms a triangle.
9. Push it in until the **gear wheel** grips it.
10. Lift the cover slightly and pull the support pin back into its joint.
11. Close the paper guide cover and both catches.
12. Switch on and hold **manual feed** until a closed pad appears at the outlet.

Manual feed runs slowly and stops the moment you let go. It is only for loading.

Load ComPackt fanfold paper

1. Switch off. Put the ComPackt stack on its shelf. Two people for a 24 kg stack.
2. Cut the bands on the stack and remove them.
3. Open both quick-release catches and lift the paper guide cover until the support pin catches.
4. Feed the paper between the deflector rollers.
5. Wrap it round the paper guide into a triangle and push it in until the gear wheel grips.
6. Release the support pin, close the cover and catches.
7. Switch on and hold manual feed until a closed pad appears.

Join the next stack, no rethreading

On stands that take two stacks, you can glue them together so paper runs straight on:

1. Run strips from the ATG glue dispenser across the top of the stack in use.
2. Put the new stack on top of the glue strips.
3. Cut and remove the bands on the new stack.

Changing an empty roll

1. Switch off.
2. Pull the locking knob and swing the roll lock out of the way.
3. Push the dancer arm to release the roll brake.
4. Take out the empty core.
5. Push the new roll into the roll seat and lock it. Check the knob clicks in.

Then thread the paper exactly as for a first load:

Catches open, cover up, under the dancer arm with a loose loop, between the deflector rollers, triangle round the paper guide, into the gear wheel, cover closed, manual feed until a closed pad appears.

Roll joins are not covered in the manual. Thread a new roll from scratch each time.

The hand control panel



Diagram of the panel layout in the manual (Fig. 64), not a photo.

1 TO 5	The five modes: **Length**, **Removal**, **Manual**, **Series** and **Preset keys 1 to 3**.
6 DISPLAY	Shows the mode and its settings. Shows **Service** when maintenance is due.
7 ESC	Cancels what you are doing, in any mode. Ends Removal and Series mode.
8 KNOB	Turn and push to choose modes and change values.
9 HAND BUTTON	Starts production in the chosen mode. The foot switch does exactly the same.

Using the knob



1. **Push** the knob. The value you can change starts to blink.
2. **Turn** it to change the value. Slowly for ones, faster for tens, fast for hundreds.
3. **Push** again to confirm. The next value starts to blink.
4. When the last value is confirmed, the machine is ready.

Shortcut: made a pad in Manual mode that is just the right length? **Hold the knob for 1 second** to copy that length into Length or Removal mode.

Mode 1: Length



One pad, the same length every time you press. The everyday mode.

1. Choose **Length** mode.
2. Set the length with the knob: 30 to 1015 cm.
3. Press the **hand button** or the **foot switch**. One pad comes out, cut.

Good for a regular box size: set it once, then just tap the foot switch for each carton.

Mode 2: Removal

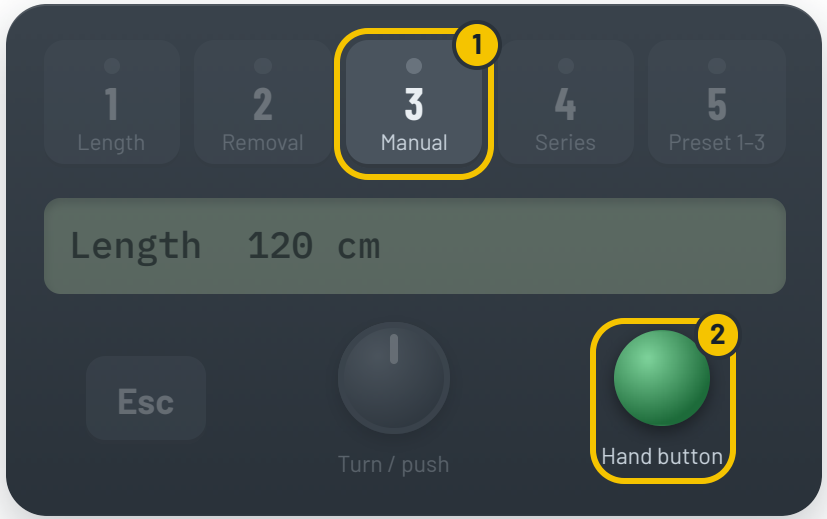


Hands-free. As soon as you take a pad, the next one is made and waiting.

1. Choose **Removal** mode and set the length.
2. Press the hand button or foot switch once to start. The mode light blinks while it is active.
3. Take pads as you need them.
4. Press **Esc** **before** you take the last pad, to stop.

Need one odd length? Hold the hand button or foot switch. You get a pad as long as you hold, then Removal mode carries on.

Mode 3: Manual



Paper runs for as long as you hold. Let go and it cuts.

1. Choose **Manual** mode.
2. Press and **hold** the hand button or foot switch.
3. **Let go** when the pad is long enough. It is cut off.
4. Like that length? Hold the knob for 1 second to save it for Length or Removal mode.

Best for odd-sized boxes, and for finding the right length for a new product.

Mode 4: Series



A set of pads with one press: up to three different lengths, each with its own count.

1. Choose **Series** mode.
2. With the knob, set a length and how many pads, for up to three steps.
3. Start it. The series runs from the top step down.
4. **Esc** ends the series.

Example: 2 × 60 cm for the base, then 1 × 120 cm to fill over the top. Every carton of that product gets the same protection.

Mode 5: Preset keys 1 to 3



Three favourite settings, one key each.

1. Choose **Preset key** mode.
2. Store a length and count against keys 1, 2 and 3.
3. Press key 1, 2 or 3 to get that pad or set of pads. Repeat as often as you like.

You can still make a one-off length at any time by holding the hand button or foot switch.

Ideal for a bench that packs three regular box sizes: small, medium, large.

Every shift

Before you start, check

- Plugs are pushed fully home.
- Service hood and paper guide cover stop the machine when opened.
- The emergency stop works.
- No dirt, paper build-up or torn paper in the machine.
- No loose screws on the service panels.

Then run

1. Paper loaded? If not, load a roll or a ComPackt stack.
2. Switch on.
3. Choose a mode and press the foot switch or hand button.

End of shift: switch off at the rocker switch.

Opening the machine

> **Unplug before you open anything** beyond the paper guide cover, and keep the plug where nobody can put it back in.

PAPER GUIDE COVER	Quick-release catches each side. Lifts up, held by a support pin. Used for every paper load.
SERVICE HOOD	Covers the cutting area. Opened to clear a paper jam.
EMBOSSING SHAFT COVER	Inside the service hood, held by two hand screws.
SERVICE PANELS	Underneath the machine. Opened for cleaning out paper scraps.

The special tool

The spanner supplied with the machine fits the **knife shaft**. You turn the shaft with it to free paper caught in the cutter. Keep it with the machine.

Clearing a paper jam

1. Switch off and unplug.
2. Open the **service hood**.
3. Undo both **hand screws** and tip them to the side, towards the pivot shaft.
4. Open the **embossing shaft cover** and pull out the paper.
5. Turn the knife shaft with the **special tool** until every scrap is out.
6. Close the embossing shaft cover and the service hood.
7. Plug in and switch on.
8. If the display asks you to **remove paper**, check it is clear and push the knob.
9. Confirm **paper removed** with the knob. The knife returns to its start position by itself.

Cleaning

Take out paper dust and scraps **at least once a week**. Build-up is a fire risk.

1. Switch off, unplug, and keep the plug out of reach.
2. Open the service panels underneath.
3. Blow or wipe out the paper dust and scraps.
4. Close the panels before you run the machine again.
5. Check the cables for loose connections, rubbing or damage.

Use

- Compressed air
- Lint-free cloths
- Isopropanol (IPA) for marks

Never

- Harsh or abrasive cleaners
- Lots of water. Cover openings first if you clean wet.

Faults and fixes

WHAT YOU SEE	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Display dark	No power, emergency stop pressed, hood open, or overheated	Plug in, pull out the emergency stop, switch on, close the hood. If overheated, off for 5 to 10 minutes.
Won't start, mode light flashes	Paper chute flap open	Check the paper chute and close the flap.
Paper keeps tearing	Roll not locked, or dirty roll brake	Lock the roll. Take it out and blow the brake clean so the dancer arm moves freely.
Switches off mid-run	Electronics too hot	Off for 10 minutes and clean the machine thoroughly.
Pads come out open	Star screws on the rotary shaft loose	Check the star screws are tight.
Message: paper build-up	Paper piling up inside or torn off	Clear the build-up and the paper.
Message: remove paper	Knife not at its start position	Clear the cutting area, then confirm with the knob.
Message: power fault	Mains voltage dipped	Switch off for 10 seconds, then back on.

If overheating or a fault keeps coming back, call us. Do not open the electrics.

Who does what

Your operators

- Loading and changing paper
- Clearing paper jams and torn paper
- Weekly clean-out of paper scraps
- Swapping the plug lead or foot switch
- Pre-shift checks

Sprick-trained service

- Service when the display shows **Service**: about every 500 rolls or 300 ComPackt stacks
- The six-monthly check of the knife shaft guard
- Spare parts and anything electrical or on the drives

Questions or a service visit: **Jo Lavene, Cotswold Packaging Group, 07930 404517**